

This is a short dhāraṇī, or protective spell, preserved in the Kangyur as Toh 79

Toh 794 · Derge Kangyur

This is a short dhāraṇī, or protective spell, preserved in the Kangyur as Toh 794. The Tibetan title line in the source gives only the opening homage to the Three Jewels and the Buddha, Dharma, and Saṅgha, followed by the invocation "Namo Hari-dhiye," and does not state an explicit title, so the text is best identified by its opening invocation. Its Sanskrit and Tibetan titles cannot be determined from the material at hand. The text consists of a mantra, partly in Sanskrit and partly in transliterated or untranslated words, together with a brief account of its ritual procedure. That account promises that merely reciting or remembering the spell, without any formal practice of accomplishment, will accomplish every action and overcome illnesses, epidemics, fevers, and harmful spirits, and it adds practical applications such as relief from hunger. Within the canon it is Toh 794 in the Kangyur, belonging to the Tantra division, where short dhāraṇīs of this kind are gathered.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the Buddha. Homage to the Dharma. Homage to the Saṅgha.

Namo Hari-dhiye. Hari-rdhi Kumāri. Gaurī. Gandhārī. Caṇḍālī. Mātaṅgī. Kali kili. Che ge mo zhig gi mo he hi. Khar khar. Paca paca. Apadhaya. Mūra-cāya. Che ge mo zhig gi ma sha manāyā svāhā. Oṃ bhura bhubā. Jvala jvala jvali manāni. De bi sarva saṃskāra karini ja. Tale tale. Jvala jvala svāhā.

As for the ritual procedure of this spell: merely by reciting it, without any formal practice of accomplishment, every action will be accomplished. Brain disease, epidemics, smoky fevers, corpse-raising demons, and harmful spirits will all be defeated. By merely remembering it, all of these will release their hold.

If you are hungry, go into a village, recite it seven times, and smear the face with it; you will find food. If you recite it upon the tongue, then at the time of cleaving a branch, the...

The passage breaks off here mid-sentence.

Translator's Notes

- The mantra syllables are transliterated rather than translated, as is proper. The phrases "che ge mo zhig gi mo" and "de bi" appear corrupt or unclear in this transmission, so I have left them as they stand and not forced a Sanskrit reconstruction. The name "Hari-dhiye" is only provisional, and "Hari-rdhi" may be a corrupted form of a goddess's name (the sequence Gaurī, Gandhārī, Caṇḍālī, Mātāṅgī recalls a known list of female deities, so this is likely a dhāraṇī to Mahāvidyā-type goddesses).

"Smoky fevers" renders "rims ldang du ba can," which is uncertain. It most likely refers to a type of epidemic fever or inflammatory illness, but the exact disease category is unclear. "Brain disease" renders "klad nad," a standard term for disorders of the brain. "Corpse-raising demons" renders "ro langs" (Skt. vetāla). "Harmful spirits" renders "gdon," a general class of malevolent beings.

The final sentence is truncated in the source, and the phrase "shags 'gyed pa'i tshe" is difficult. It may refer to splitting or cutting a branch, but I have not forced a reading.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.